

How's your metacognition?

What happens when experts in one field wander to another subject entirely?
This version of Dunning-Kruger explains a lot. That's our next topic.

[371](#) Go Blue!

[372](#) Justin Kruger and David Dunning, "Unskilled and Unaware of It: How Difficulties in Recognizing One's Own Incompetence Lead to Inflated Self-Assessments," *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology* 77(6) (December 1999).

[373](#) Ironically, the DKE curve was not created by its authors, but was formed in popular culture as people wrestled with understanding their own lacking skill sets. Years later, Dunning and Kruger researched the curve and discovered it was fairly accurate.

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The film was based on Chuck Palahniuk's 1996 novel, *Fight Club*. The exact language spoken by Tyler Durden, the character played by Brad Pitt: "The first rule of Fight Club is: you do not talk about Fight Club. The second rule of Fight Club is: you DO NOT talk about Fight Club! Third rule of Fight Club: someone yells "stop!", goes limp, taps out, the fight is over. Fourth rule: only two guys to a fight. Fifth rule: one fight at a time, fellas. Sixth rule: No shirts, no shoes. Seventh rule: fights will go on as long as they have to. And the eighth and final rule: if this is your first time at Fight Club, you have to fight."

[375](#) "Daniel Kahneman on Bias," socialsciencespace.com (January 4, 2013). Full quote: "Well undoubtedly there is bias in science, and there are many biases, and I certainly do not claim to be immune from them. I suffer from all of them. We tend to favor our hypotheses. We tend to believe that things are going to work, and sometimes we delude ourselves in believing our conclusions."

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Benjamin Graham (updated by Jason Zweig), *The Intelligent Investor: The Definitive Book on Value Investing* (First published in 1949). Latest edition, Harper Business, 3rd Edition, 2024.